PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

May 13, 2026
Budget Hearing and Work Session on the 2026-27 Proposed Budget

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Budget Hearing and Work Session on the 2026-27 Proposed Budget of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Benson High School, 546 NE 12th Ave, Portland, OR 97232, and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Director Rashelle Chase-Miller; Director Stephanie Englesman; Director Virginia La Forte; Director Christy Splitt; Director Patte Sullivan; Student Representative Ian Ritorto; and Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong.

Call to Order

Board Chair Eddie Wang called the meeting to order and the Board convened as the budget committee at 6:10 pm.

Public Comment on the 2026-27 Proposed Budget

Staff: Michelle Morrison - Chief Financial Officer

Staff provided an overview of the 2026-27 Proposed Budget.

The Budget Committee heard public comment:

- Saday Mesa Arias - In support of Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) Programs
- Lopez: Student in support of Early Escolara Program
- Xander Bedel - In support of continuing transportation to ACCESS
- Wolfie Sparbel - In support of continuing transportation to ACCESS
- Sebastian Ferreira Castro - In support of the Early Escolara Program
- Sarah Bernal - Student in support of the programs provided by Latino Network
- Peter Ruf - Benson student in support of CTE programs
- Ellie Larson - In support of transportation to ACCESS
- Jalil Shamsud-Din - In support of maintaining funding to Self Enhancement Inc and other partners.
- Rachel Weisshaar - In support of transportation to ACCESS
- Zara Faruky - Benson student in support of maintaining funding for the school paper.
- Lisa Jackson - Advocated in housing and environmental funding for school districts.
- Maria Zavala- Read comments from Margarita Wilson, AP at DaVinci Middle School, in support of funding Community Based Programs
- Brenda Chavez-Olguin - In support of the Early Escolara Program
- Gillian Murr - Remember Native Students in the proposed budget.
- Joshua Shalek - In support of transportation to ACCESS
- Tracy Connor - In support of transportation to ACCESS
- Seth Kaufman - In support of transportation to ACCESS

- Michael Rabby - In support of transportation to ACCESS
- David Contreras Machado - Please continue to fund RESJ initiatives like Latino Network
- Phil Berlin - Please restore all RESJ funds.
- Diana Marcela Cuartas - Please maintain funds to Latino Network
- Amy Alvarado Martinez - In support of the Early Escolara Program and funding Latino Network
- Chris Walters - Advocated for a cost of living increase greater than 1%.
- Noah Johnson-Green - Support technical theater programs
- Marlene Lopez-Patton - Please continue to fund RESJ initiatives like Latino Network
- A'Nova Ettien - Please protect focused options schools like Buckman
- Marguri Bernal Chamueero - Please continue to fund RESJ initiatives like Latino Network

2026-27 Budget Work Session

Board members' discussion focused on understanding the impacts of proposed reductions, identifying opportunities for additional budget transparency, and exploring alternatives to planned cuts. Members requested more information on the impact of reductions to Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) initiatives. There were questions about transportation reimbursement funds, the status of Career and Technical Education (CTE) reductions, and the potential unintended consequences of ACCESS students returning to their neighborhood schools due to transportation issues. There were requests to consider delaying transportation cuts while exploring co-location or alternative service models, and examine whether transportation flexibility offered to ACCESS families could also apply to Dual Language Immersion (DLI) programs. Board members also sought updates on a furlough day for Service Employee International Union SEIU) employees, and Indian Education engagement efforts.

Chair Wang adjourned the Board as a Budget Committee at 8:19 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
Senior Board Operations Manager, Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools
